Year 9 Admission Assessment: assessor booklet

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Year group applied for	
Current school	
Date of assessment	
Assessor	

Who this is for. Students applying for **Year 9** (age 13 on 1 September). A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 7 (初一)**; a student joining mid-year is partway through Grade 8. Ask the student and the family which grade and which textbooks they have used, because the order of topics differs between textbooks and regions. Background on Chinese school sequences, the English bands and the decision guide is in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

What it measures. The student's level of English in listening, reading, writing and speaking (bands A to E), their maths and science against the UK Year 8 curriculum (what a Year 9 student should know on entry), and, through the interview, who they are, their future plans and their suitability for the programme.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Print
1	Welcome	2	Assessor		This booklet
2	Listening: 8 questions (8 marks)	5	Assessor reads the script (Section 3.1); a small group is fine	Student paper pages 2 to 3; pencil	Student paper
3	Reading paper: Parts A, B and C (24 marks)	12	Student works alone	Student paper pages 4 to 9	
4	Writing: one task from two (16 marks)	10	Student works alone	Student paper pages 10 to 11	
5	Break	3 to 5		Water	
6	Maths: Section A Number problems, Section B Word problems and pictures (30 marks)	20	Student works alone; the assessor may read any question aloud	Student paper pages 12 to 17; pencil, rubber, ruler; **no calculator, no protractor**	
7	Science: 7 questions (10 marks)	8	Student works alone; the assessor may read any question aloud	Student paper pages 18 to 21	
8	Interview, opening with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen at **Level 8**	15	Interviewer, 1:1	Sentence Reading Card (laminated); a plain card to cover sentences	Sentence Reading Record; Interview Record Years 7 to 10
	Total	**about 70 to 75**		A clock or timer	Candidate Summary and Decision

Files: `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record`, `forms/Interview_Record_Y7_Y10`, `forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`.

The parent conversation (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`, about 15 minutes) can run at the same time with another member of staff. The written papers (tasks 2 to 7) can be taken in a small group with one invigilator; the interview is always 1:1.

2. Before you start

Room. Quiet, bright, a clock the student can see, the student paper face down, a pencil, rubber and ruler. Glasses or hearing aids if the student uses them.

Say (welcome): "Hello, I am [name]. Thank you for coming today. These activities help us get to know you, so that we can help you when you join us. Some questions are easy and some are hard. Nobody gets everything right, and that is fine. Do your best. If you do not know an answer, go on to the next question. In the English parts, I can only repeat the instructions. In maths and science, I can read any question to you. Do you have any questions before we start?"

Access rules (the same in every year group)

	English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	**Maths and science**
Reading aloud	Read only what the script says. Do not read the reading texts or questions aloud, explain words or translate. Instructions may be repeated in English.	Any question may be read aloud in English, as often as the student asks. You may point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used. Note anything the student says in Chinese that shows understanding.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student clearly cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Write **L** in the margin. The mark still counts.
Answers in Chinese	Do not score. Note them.	Accepted in explanations; write **L**.
Not yet taught		If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0. List NT topics in the score summary.

Extra time, a reader or other arrangements for a known need are allowed: record them in the score summary.

Stopping rules

- The student may stop any section when they have done what they can. Say: "That is fine. Thank you. We will go on to the next part."
- **Reading paper:** if the student cannot answer any of Part A after about 4 minutes, let them stop and record it. Do not move them on to Parts B and C.
- **Writing:** if the student has written nothing in English after 3 minutes, say once: "Write anything you can in English: a few words or sentences about yourself is fine." Then let them stop when they wish.
- **Maths and science:** encourage the student to look at every page, because later questions on different topics may be easier for them. Do not stop early unless the student is distressed.
- If a student becomes upset at any point, stop, take a break, and continue only if they are happy to. Record it.

Keeping the student at ease. Smile, use the student's name, and keep your voice calm. Do not say "right" or "wrong" during the tasks; say "thank you" instead. Give a two-minute warning before the end of the reading paper, maths and science. A student who finishes early may check their work quietly.

3. English

3.1 Listening (5 minutes, 8 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Listening page. You will hear two friends, Mei and Tom, talking about a science club trip. I will read it two times. First, you have one minute to read the questions." Wait one minute. **Say:** "Now listen." Read the script. Wait 10 seconds. **Say:** "Now listen again." Read it again. Then give the student one more minute to finish.

Read it twice at a natural, steady pace (about the speed of a teacher talking to a class). Say each speaker's name before their line, a little more quietly, both times. At each [pause], stop for about 3 seconds. Do not slow down for key words, repeat lines or explain anything.

Script: Planning the Saturday trip

Mei: Hi, Tom. Are you coming on the science club trip on Saturday?

Tom: Yes, I am. But I've lost the letter. Where are we going again?

Mei: To the Science and Technology Museum. The robot exhibition has finished, but there's a new exhibition about space. They've got a real rocket engine! [pause]

Tom: Cool. What time do we meet?

Mei: At half past eight, at the school gate. The coach leaves at a quarter to nine, so don't be late. [pause]

Tom: Do I need to bring any money?

Mei: The museum ticket is free for students. Lunch in the museum café costs forty yuan, or you can bring a packed lunch. [pause]

Tom: I'll bring my own lunch. My grandma makes amazing dumplings. What's the weather going to be like?

Mei: Cloudy in the morning, and rain in the afternoon. Bring an umbrella. But most of the day is inside, anyway. [pause]

Tom: OK. When do we get back?

Mei: At about five o'clock. Oh, and Mr Zhang says everyone must bring their student card. You can't get a free ticket without it. [pause]

Tom: My student card! I think it's still in my PE bag. I'd better check tonight.

Mei: Good idea. Last time, Jun forgot his card, and he had to wait at the ticket office for twenty minutes while Mr Zhang phoned the school.

Tom: Poor Jun. I don't want that to happen to me. See you on Saturday! [pause]

Answers (1 mark each). Spelling does not matter in listening if the meaning is clear (for example "studen kard").

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
1	**A** (the rocket: space)		B (robots: the exhibition that has finished)
2	**B** (8:30)		A (8:45 is when the coach leaves)
3	**C** (rain)		B (cloudy is the morning)
4	**40** (yuan)	forty; ¥40	
5	**(their) student card**	student ID; school card; card	ticket; money; umbrella
6	**(about) five o'clock**	5; 5:00; 17:00; five; 5 pm	8:30 or 8:45
7	**The rain will not be a big problem.**		
8	**To warn Tom, or to remind him why he must bring his card**	Any answer that shows what happened to Jun because he forgot his card (he had to wait 20 minutes), or that Mei does not want the same thing to happen to Tom	"Jun is her friend"; "Jun was late"; an answer about lunch or dumplings

Band guide

Score	0 to 2	3 to 4	5 to 6	7	8
Listening band	A	B	C	D	E

What to look for

- Questions 1 to 3 check the main points; 4 to 6 need exact detail and include distractors (8:45, cloudy, robots); 7 and 8 need implied meaning. A student who gets 1 to 6 but not 7 and 8 follows everyday talk but not yet what is meant: usually C.
- A wrong answer that is a distractor (8:45, B in question 3) shows the student heard words but not how they connect ("leaves at", "in the morning").
- Compare with listening in the interview (how much of your English the student understood). If the two differ by more than one band, use the interview as a check: some students freeze in a test, and some hide gaps in conversation with good routines.

3.2 Reading paper (12 minutes, 24 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Reading page. There are three parts, A, B and C. Each part is harder. Read the texts yourself. I cannot read them to you or explain words. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. You have 12 minutes." Give a two-minute warning.

General rules. Answers can be in the student's own words or copied from the text, unless the question says "copy". Ignore spelling and grammar unless the answer cannot be understood (except question 12). Answers in Chinese do not score; note them.

Part A: sports centre poster (very accessible; picture support)

Q	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
1	Swimming	1	swim
2	¥15	1	15; 15 yuan
3	Yoga	1	
4	A swimming cap	1	cap; swim hat. Do not accept "money" or "student card".
5	False, True, True, False	2	All four correct: 2. Three correct: 1. Two or fewer: 0 (two is the score from guessing).
6	**No** and a reason: climbing is for ages 13 and over; he is too young; he is only 12	1	Both parts needed. "No" alone: 0.
7	Table tennis	1	Climbing is on Saturday afternoon, so "climbing" does not score.

Part B: "Why Do Pandas Eat All Day?" (non-fiction, about two years below age level)

Q	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
8	In (the mountain forests of) central China	1	China; in mountain forests; in the mountains. Do not accept "in a zoo" or "bamboo".
9	14 (hours)	1	up to 14. Do not accept 12 (that is the kilograms).
10	They get very little energy from bamboo	1	Their body is made for eating meat, so it cannot use bamboo well; bamboo has little energy. Do not accept "because they like bamboo" or "they are hungry" without a reason.
11	A bone in its wrist that works like a thumb	1	thumb; wrist bone; a long bone. Do not accept "teeth", or "hand" or "paw" alone.
12	tiny	1	Must be the copied word, spelt correctly.
13	"Pandas move slowly to save energy." and "A newborn panda weighs about the same as an apple."	2	1 mark for each correct tick, minus 1 for each wrong tick (minimum 0).

Q	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
14	Forests are protected, and scientists work carefully to help pandas	1	Either idea: protected forests; scientists; people protect them.

Part C: "Halfway Up" (fiction, age-appropriate for a fluent reader of 13)

Q	Skill	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
15	Retrieval	Eight metres	1	8 m; 8. Do not accept 2 metres (the training height).
16	Vocabulary and meaning in context	"Mei knew the move was easy, but she still felt afraid."	1	
17	Retrieval and inference	Any **two** of: her arms shook; sweat made her fingers slippery; her breathing was fast and loud; she wanted to be lowered down or give up; "one terrible second"; she was "not so sure"; the coach's voice sounded far away; something tight in her chest	2	1 mark each, own words or quotation. Do not accept "she looked up" or "she was eight metres up" alone.
18	Author's purpose	To show the pressure on Mei: she does not want to be the only one who fails; she feels she must reach the top too	1	To make the reader worry that she will fail; to make her feel worse or more nervous. Do not accept a retelling with no purpose ("because they reached the top").
19	Inference	The sign was funny or sweet (her little brother made it; "MEI CAN FLY"), and it made her feel better	1	Either idea: it was funny or cute; her brother's support cheered her up or made her less nervous. Do not accept "she was happy" with no reason.
20	Vocabulary in context	It suddenly became very loud; everyone started cheering at once	1	very loud; suddenly noisy; people shouted and clapped. Do not accept a literal explosion or "something broke".
21	Inference across the text	From frightened or nervous (start) to happy, proud, relieved or confident (end)	1	Both ends needed.

Band guide (use judgement when a result is uneven, and check against the sentence reading screen)

Result	Band
Part A under 4	**A** New to English
Part A 4 or more, Part B under 4	**B** Early acquisition
Part B 4 or more, Part C under 3	**C** Developing competence
Part C 3 to 5	**D** Competent
Part C 6 to 8	**E** Fluent

What to look for

- **Strong readers** answer Part C in their own words, explain *why* (questions 18 and 19), and see the change in feeling (21). Retrieval-only answers in Part C, with inference questions blank, usually mean band C or a low D.
- **An English barrier** looks like: Part A secure, Part B patchy, Part C blank or copied lines that do not answer the question. A student who reads aloud well (sentence reading) but scores low on Parts B and C may be decoding without understanding: see the meaning checks on the sentence reading record.
- **Speed.** Note where the student was when time ran out. A student who answers everything they reach correctly but does not reach Part C may be a slow but accurate reader: give a D or C by judgement and say so.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Writing page. Choose one task, A or B, and tick the box. You can plan in the box, then write on the lines. You have 10 minutes. Write as much as you can." Do not explain the tasks or words.

The tasks. Task A (narrative): a story that begins "When I opened my bag, I found something that was not mine." Task B (opinion): an article for the school magazine, "Should every school day include one hour of sport?", with an opinion and at least two reasons. The plan is not marked.

Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 fall between the descriptions).

Criterion	0	2	4 (what a fluent 13 year old would do)
Content and organisation	Nothing relevant in English, or a few words copied from the task.	Relevant to the task; ideas in a sensible order but little developed; may be one block of text; the story stops rather than ends, or the article lists reasons without explaining them.	Well developed and clearly organised in paragraphs. Story: an opening that follows on from the given sentence, a problem, some description or tension, an ending. Article: a clear opinion, two or more reasons with examples or explanation, a conclusion; suits a magazine reader.
Vocabulary	Isolated words, or only words from the prompt.	Everyday words used correctly but repeated ("good", "very", "nice"); a few words chosen for effect; simple linking (and, but, because).	Wide and precise vocabulary, some ambitious words used correctly; a range of linking words (however, although, as a result, suddenly); topic words (fitness, stress, concentrate).
Grammar and sentences	No sentences.	Mostly simple sentences, some joined with and, but, because; frequent errors in verb tense, plurals and articles, but the meaning is clear.	A variety of sentence types, including complex sentences (when, although, which, if); tenses controlled (past tense in the story); errors are rare and do not affect meaning.
Spelling and punctuation	Mostly impossible to read.	Common words spelt correctly; capital letters and full stops mostly correct; errors in less common words.	Almost all words spelt correctly, including ambitious ones; full stops, commas, question marks, apostrophes and (in a story) speech marks used correctly.

Band by best fit, using the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, and the notes below. The total is a check, not a rule: as a rough guide, totals of 0 to 3 usually go with A, 4 to 7 with B, 8 to 10 with C, 11 to 13 with D and 14 to 16 with E.

Band	Writing at Year 9 entry
A	Name, isolated words or copied phrases; may write in Chinese.
B	A few short sentences on the topic, with frequent errors; meaning mostly clear.
C	A short connected piece (often 60 to 120 words) with some joined sentences; errors frequent but rarely block meaning; little paragraphing.
D	An organised piece (often 120 to 200 words) with paragraphs and a range of sentences; generally accurate with occasional errors; some varied vocabulary.
E	See below.

Band E writing at this age. A fluent 13 year old usually writes 150 to 250 words in 10 minutes, in paragraphs, with a clear opening and ending, a range of sentence types used for effect, controlled tenses, precise and sometimes ambitious vocabulary, and mostly accurate spelling and punctuation. The story has a voice and some suspense; the article sounds like an article (it speaks to the reader, gives reasons and examples, and ends with a conclusion).

What to look for

- Typical features of English from speakers of Chinese (missing articles, plural -s, past tense -ed, third person -s) are normal at bands C and D. Do not let them alone pull a well-organised, well-developed piece below D.
- A memorised opening ("Once upon a time", "Nowadays, with the development of society") followed by very simple writing shows exam training more than fluency: band by what the student can produce independently.

- A student who plans well (clear notes in the plan box) but writes little may have the ideas but not yet the English: note it, because it points to good progress with support.

3.4 Interview, speaking and sentence reading (15 minutes, 1:1)

Use `forms/Interview_Record_Y7_Y10` for the interview and `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record` for the sentence reading. Both are in English.

- **Sentence reading first** (3 to 5 minutes). Year 9 starts at **Level 8 (sentence 22)**. Follow the start, going-back and stopping rules and the scoring on the record. It gives total points out of 72, an indicative reading age, meaning checks and a fluency rating. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1.
- **Interview** (about 10 minutes): choose questions from each block on the form, including **future plans and aspirations** and the suitability strands. Use the easier and stretch prompts so that every student can show their best spoken English.
- **Speaking band:** circle it on the interview record, using the descriptors there, and copy it to the score summary below. Pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand.

4. Maths (20 minutes, 30 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Maths page. You have 20 minutes. Write your answers in the boxes and show your working. I can read any question to you in English. You may not use a calculator. Do as much as you can, and look at every page." The example box at the start of Section A shows what the command words Expand, Factorise and Solve mean; it is there so that an English word does not hide maths the student knows.

Sections. Section A, **Number problems** (questions 1 to 6, 9 marks): calculation and algebra with no context. Section B, **Word problems and pictures** (questions 7 to 18, 21 marks): **word problems** (questions 7 to 10, 7 marks) and problems with diagrams, pictures and tables (questions 11 to 18, 14 marks). Questions 6 and 18 are ceiling items from the Year 9 curriculum; questions 1, 2 and 7 are floor items.

Marking. M = method mark, A = accuracy mark (depends on the method), B = independent mark. A correct answer with no working gets full marks unless the scheme says otherwise. Units are not needed unless stated. Answers in Chinese in working are fine (mark L only if language support was given).

What a Year 9 entrant may not have been taught. A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually completed **Grade 7 (初一)**: operations with negative numbers, algebraic expressions and "removing brackets", linear equations and inequalities, angles and parallel lines, square roots, coordinates and simultaneous equations. Grade 8 topics (factorising, multiplying out double brackets, Pythagoras, polygon angle sums, linear functions and graphs, weighted mean) **may not have been taught yet**. Probability as a number is often met in Grade 9. Use NT and judge whether the student would reach the expected band once taught.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
Section A	**Number problems**			
1	Negative numbers (floor)	(a) 5 (b) –18	B1 each	Usually secure (Grade 6 to 7).
2	Index notation	7	B1. 16 – 9. A wrong answer of 2 (from 8 – 6) shows powers read as multiplication.	Usually secure (Grade 7, 乘方).
3	Expand; factorise	(a) $8x - 12$ (b) $3(2y + 5)$	B1 each. (b) accept $3(5 + 2y)$.	(a) usually secure ("removing brackets", Grade 7). (b) factorising is Grade 8 (因式分解): may not have been taught.
4	Equation with brackets and unknowns on both sides	$x = 4$	M1 for $3x + 12 = x + 20$ or $2x = 8$; A1 for 4.	Usually secure (Grade 7).

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
5	Linear inequality	$x \leqslant 5$	B1. Accept $5 \geqslant x$. Do not accept $x = 5$ or $x < 5$.	Usually secure (Grade 7).
6	Double brackets (ceiling)	$x^2 + 8x + 15$	B1 for the simplified answer. If $x^2 + 3x + 5x + 15$ is seen but not simplified: 0, but note "expands correctly".	Grade 8 (整式的乘法): may not have been taught.
Section B	**Word problems**			
7	Percentage of an amount (one step)	14	B1	Secure (Grade 6).
8	Direct proportion, money (two steps)	¥56	M1 for ¥7 for one notebook, or 35 × 8 ÷ 5, or 35 + 21; A1 for 56.	Secure (Grade 6).
9	Percentage decrease, money (two steps)	¥180	M1 for 60 (25% of 240), or 240 × 0.75, or 240 × 3/4; A1 for 180. An answer of 60 scores M1 only.	Secure: Chinese students know discounts well (75% of the price is 七五折).
10	Speed, distance, time (two steps)	750 km	M1 for 2.5 hours seen, or 300 × 2 + 150, or 300 × 2.5; A1 for 750. An answer of 690 (using 2.3 hours) scores 0 but shows a time conversion error: note it.	Secure (primary: 速度 × 时间 = 路程).
Section B	**Diagrams, pictures and tables**			
11	Probability (spinner)	3/8	B1. Accept 0.375, 37.5%, "3 out of 8". Do not accept 3 : 5 or 3 : 8.	Probability as a fraction is often Grade 9 (概率): may not have been taught, although "likelihood" is met in primary.
12	Parallel lines; angles on a line	$a = 62°$, $b = 118°$	B1 each. b: follow through 180 – their a. Reasons not needed.	Secure (Grade 7, 平行线).
13	Circumference and area of a circle	(a) 31.4 cm (b) 78.5 cm²	B1 each. Accept 10π and 25π. An area of 314 (using the diameter as the radius) scores 0: note it.	Secure (Grade 6).
14	Interior angle of a regular hexagon	120°	B1	Polygon angle sums are Grade 8 (多边形内角和): may not have been taught. Some students reason from six equilateral triangles.
15	Volume of a triangular prism	120 cm³	M1 for 12 (the triangle area, ½ × 6 × 4) or ½ × 6 × 4 × 10; A1 for 120. An answer of 240 (no ½) scores 0: note it.	Usually secure (volume = base area × height, Grade 5 to 6).
16	Mean from a frequency table	2.1	M1 for 42 (0 + 3 + 16 + 15 + 8) or 42 ÷ 20; A1 for 2.1. Answers of 2 (mode or median) or 4 (20 ÷ 5) score 0.	The weighted mean is Grade 8 (加权平均数): may not have been taught, although the simple mean is met in Grade 4.
17	Straight-line graph	(a) 1, 3, 5 (b) a straight line through (0, –1) and (4, 7)	(a) B1 for all three. (b) B1 for a ruled straight line through at least four correct points from $x = 0$ to 4 (follow through from their table if their points are on a straight line).	Linear functions are Grade 8 (一次函数): may not have been taught. Coordinates are secure (Grade 7).
18	Pythagoras' theorem (ceiling)	13 m	M1 for $12^2 + 5^2$ or 169; A1 for 13. An answer of 17 (12 + 5) scores 0.	Grade 8 (勾股定理): may not have been taught.

Totals: Section A / 9, Section B / 21 (of which word problems, questions 7 to 10: / 7). **Band guide** (provisional): 0 to 11: **1** Well below expected; 12 to 17: **2** Working towards; 18 to 25: **3** Expected; 26 to 30: **4** Greater depth.

Not tested this year (not enough time): rotation and enlargement, scatter graphs, inequalities shown on a number line. Ask about them in the interview if they matter for placement.

What to look for

- **Number problems against word problems.** A student who scores well on Section A but poorly on the word problems (questions 7 to 10) may have an **English barrier rather than a maths difficulty**. Check by reading the word problem aloud in English, and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese (mark it L). If the student then solves it quickly, record the barrier: it points to English support in maths lessons, not to a lower maths set.
- **Strong responses** show clear, organised working, correct units, and confidence on the Grade 8 topics (factorising, Pythagoras, graphs). Many students from Chinese schools calculate quickly and accurately but leave out working: that is a habit, not a weakness, but they will need to show working in IGCSE later.
- **Weak responses** show errors on taught topics (negative numbers, equations, percentages), not just on NT topics. If most of the lost marks are NT questions, write the likely band once taught in the summary.

5. Science (8 minutes, 10 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Science page. You have 8 minutes. I can read any question to you in English. Do as much as you can."

What a Year 9 entrant may not have been taught. In Chinese middle schools, biology starts in Grade 7 (cells, plants, the human body, digestion, breathing, food chains), physics in Grade 8 and chemistry only in Grade 9. A Year 9 entrant has usually done **some biology but no secondary physics or chemistry**. Questions 4 to 6 may not have been taught: mark NT rather than reading this as weak science, and judge the student's scientific thinking from questions 5 and 7.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
1	Food webs	(a) grass (b) "It goes up" **and** fewer frogs eat them	(a) B1. (b) B1 for the tick with a correct reason; the tick alone scores 0.	Secure (Grade 7 biology, 食物网).
2	Photosynthesis word equation	oxygen	B1. Accept O_2.	Secure (Grade 7 biology), but the English words "glucose" and "carbon dioxide" may be new: read them aloud.
3	Digestion	C (small intestine)	B1	Secure (Grade 7 biology, 消化和吸收).
4	Elements, compounds and mixtures	(a) B (b) C	B1 each	Chemistry is Grade 9: may not have been taught.
5	Conservation of mass	150.0 g	B1. Accept 150.	Grade 9 chemistry (质量守恒定律): may not have been taught, but a good scientific thinker can reason it from "nothing can get in or out".
6	Current in a series circuit	0.3 A	B1	Series circuits are Grade 9 physics: may not have been taught; simple circuits are met in primary.
7	Electromagnet: fair test and pattern in a table	(a) One control variable: the same battery (or voltage), the same nail, the same kind of paper clips, the same wire (b) 12	B1 each. (a) Do not accept "number of turns" (the variable he changes) or "number of paper clips" (what he measures).	Electromagnets are met in some primary textbooks and in Grade 9 physics; the working scientifically skills are the main point.

Band guide (provisional): 0 to 3: **1**; 4 to 5: **2**; 6 to 8: **3**; 9 to 10: **4**. Look at the NT questions before deciding.

What to look for

- **Working scientifically** (questions 5 and 7): a student who explains a fair test and spots the pattern in a table is likely to do well once taught, even with several NT questions.
- **An English barrier** looks like: blank or wrong answers that become right when you read the question aloud, or explanations written in Chinese (mark L). Science vocabulary in English (producer, compound, mixture, ammeter) is often the gap: note the words the student did not know.
- **Strong responses** give the reason as well as the answer in question 1(b) and name a sensible control variable in question 7(a).

6. Score summary

Copy to `forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`.

Part	Score	Band	Notes (NT, L, access arrangements, behaviour)
Listening	___ / 8	A B C D E	
Reading paper	___ / 24 (A ___ / 8, B ___ / 8, C ___ / 8)	A B C D E	
Sentence reading (shared record)	points ___ / 72; reading age _____	indicative: A B C D E	Meaning checks: Fluency:
Writing (task A or B)	___ / 16 (content ___, vocabulary ___, grammar ___, spelling and punctuation ___)	A B C D E	
Speaking (from the interview)		A B C D E	
Maths	___ / 30 (A ___ / 9, B ___ / 21, of which word problems ___ / 7)	1 2 3 4	NT: L:
Science	___ / 10	1 2 3 4	NT: L:
Overall English (the band most skills sit in; name any skill two or more bands lower)		A B C D E	

Assessor's comment (strengths, English barrier or not, NT topics and the likely maths and science band once taught, anything to follow up):

Assessor signature and date _____